
Deborah Hospital

Marketing and Public Relations Unit

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Company Access

Deborah Heart and Lung Center in Browns Mills New Jersey



Lewis Clark, VP of Marketing and
Public Relations

Background Information

Deborah's Mission: provide specialized and high-quality cardiovascular and pulmonary care to improve the quality of life for patients and their families.

Deborah has a very diverse workforce including includes cardiologists, pulmonologists, surgeons, nurses, medical technicians, and various support staff such as administrators and facilities management.

One of Deborah's major competitors is Cooper University Health Care in Camden, NJ, which also offers advanced heart and lung treatment.

Data Collection

Data was collected through interviews and surveys sent to department members

Key Interviews:

Lewis Clark- VP of Marketing and Public Relations
(2/19/2025 & 3/25/2025)

David Cohen- Patient Experience coordinator
(3/11/2025)

Jennifer Johnston- Marketing Director (3/11/2025)

Goals:

to gain a generic understanding of employees' attitudes and understanding of their company's goals and values, as well as to see the manager's mindset and reasoning behind the company's goals and values.

Deborah Heart and Lung Center's Output Problem

Output Problem/Challenge: The issue we were given to analyze within Deborah Heart and Lung Center was a lack of employee morale and motivation, thought to be caused by a post-COVID setting.

Opportunity: To further improve communication and employee engagement past its predicted and existing levels.

Manager's Perspective: Lack of morale and motivation was thought to have stemmed from a lack of clarity in communication.

Employee Perspective(s): More focused on improvements surrounding day-to-day tasks (employee surveys) and expressed a desire for more frequent meetings around project-specific goals (Jennifer Johnston).

First Concept: Motivation & Expectancy Theory

Motivation: Factors that drive employees to put in effort and stay engaged with their work and daily tasks.

Expectancy Theory: People, or employees in this context, decide how much effort to give based on what they believe the outcome of their efforts will be.

If employees cannot see a clear connection between what they do and how it benefits them or the company, their motivation drops as a result.

Evidence #1 for Motivation/Expectancy Theory

In Practice (Jennifer Johnston, Director of Marketing):

Gaps in project-specific communication left staff unsure if employees' efforts were aligned with goals or valued by leadership, lowering motivation.

Secondary Research (Hackman & Porter, 1968):

Employee effort and engagement are stronger when there is a clear link between performance and meaningful rewards. A lack of feedback and recognition likely contributed to lower morale at Deborah.

Evidence #2 for Motivation Theory

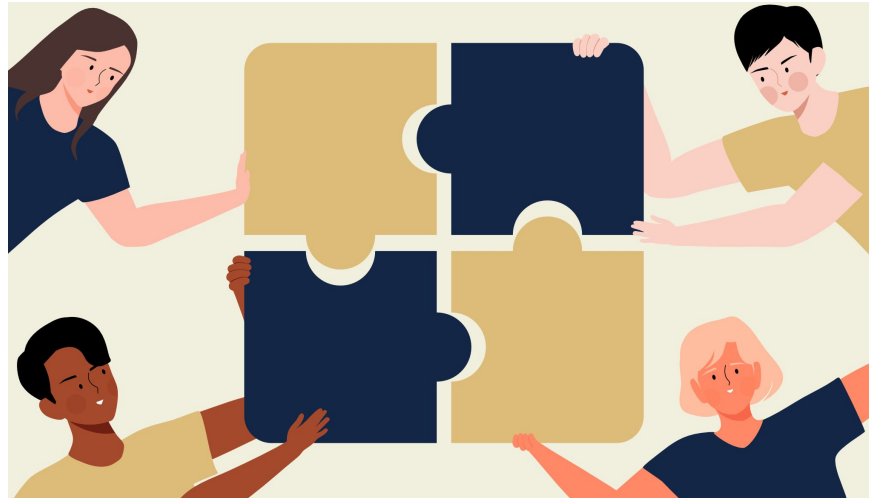
In Practice (Daniel Cohen, Patient Experience Coordinator):

Noted that suggestions and ideas often went unacknowledged for extended periods of time for individuals working at Deborah Hospital. A lack of recognition or response had caused a feeling of being undervalued and as a result, decreased motivation within the team.

Secondary Research (Lambrou et al., 2010): “We found that amongst healthcare professionals, achievements and remuneration were factors that motivated employees to work harder.”

Course Concept #2: Team Effectiveness & Processes

Definition: How well a group works together to achieve a common goal. A highly effective team has clear roles, open communication, shared goals, and processes in place that keep it organized and productive



Evidence #1 for Team Effectiveness & Processes

“Teams that are built on certain ethical values—such as fairness, respect, transparency, and cooperation—are more likely to communicate effectively and maintain higher levels of communication (Mercader et al., 2021)”

Evidence #2 for Team Effectiveness & Processes

In Practice

Manager's perspective: Lewis Clark, VP of Marketing

- Realised that their lack of effectiveness was due to a lack of communication within the organization.
- Decided to implement communication strategies to enforce clear and frequent communication with all employees
- The organization now has a letter from the CEO that goes to all employees.

Employee's Perspective: Jennifer Johnston, Director of Marketing

- Believes that the letter from CEO has helped bridged the gap between upper and lower-level employees and tackled the issue of inconsistent communication
- Has a positive attitude towards the implemented changes, showing how clear communication has been established, which enforces better team effectiveness

First Recommendation

- Implement a Structured Recognition and Feedback Program
- Employees are more motivated when they believe that their efforts will lead to recognition or a desired outcome
- Improve morale, strengthen engagement, and increase motivation

Best Practices and Potential Downsides

- Risk of perceived favoritism: Without clear criteria, some employees may feel overlooked.
 - Best Practice: Use transparent metrics and peer nominations. [Google]
- Cost of implementation: Time and resources are needed to set up and maintain the program.
 - Best Practice: Start small and affordable, automate where possible. [Zappos]
- Risk of feedback fatigue: Too much or poorly delivered feedback may overwhelm staff.
 - Best Practice: Train managers and tailor feedback frequency to employee preferences. [Adobe]

Second Recommendation

- Introduce regular cross-team meetings to improve communication and collaboration.
- Meetings should be structured and have a clear purpose to ensure productivity.
- Foster team engagement and participation to enhance overall teamwork.

Best Practices & Potential Downsides

- **Risk of "meeting fatigue":** Unstructured or unclear meetings may lead to disengagement and decreased participation.
 - **Cost of implementation:** Time and resources are required to organize and attend the meetings, disrupting regular workflows.
 - **Unintended consequences:** Meetings may highlight existing communication gaps or inefficiencies, causing frustration and demotivation if not addressed.
- **Best Practices**
 - Mayo Clinic: Uses team huddles for goal alignment, role clarity, and patient care coordination.
 - Salesforce: Implements "V2MOM" meetings for clarity, accountability, and adaptive collaboration.
 - Benefits: Enhances team effectiveness and communication.

Communication Strategies & Influencing Tactics

- **Reciprocity:**
 - Offer a trial period for both recommendations (recognition program and cross-team meetings).
 - Provide value upfront to build goodwill and encourage full implementation.
- **Social Proof:**
 - Successful case studies (e.g., Google's recognition program, Mayo Clinic's cross-functional meetings).
 - Shows that similar organizations have had positive results, reducing perceived risk.
- **Combined Strategy:**
 - Use both principles to build trust and confidence, addressing client resistance effectively.